

How to use this book

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This workbook provides questions for you to practise what you have learnt in the Learner's Book. There is a unit to match each unit in your Learner's Book. Each session is divided into three parts:

Focus: these questions help you to master the basics

Focus

1 Discuss three paragraphs from a short story about a sailor. In the right-hand column, write down what information is told from the reader's viewpoint. The first one has been done for you.

Paragraph content	What information the reader doesn't know
1 A sailor returned a long time ago to his home to get his wife and children. He was very tired and had a long journey home.	What the sailor is, why he has been away, the sailor's wife and children.
2 The sailor was very tired and had a long journey home. He was very tired and had a long journey home.	
3 The sailor was very tired and had a long journey home. He was very tired and had a long journey home.	

Practice: these questions help you to become more confident in using what you have learnt

Practice

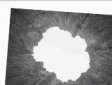
2 Look at the text below. Which of the paragraphs is the most important? Write down the paragraph number in the box.

- ONLY AT ALL PARTS:**
- (1) ...
 - (2) ...
 - (3) ...

Challenge: these questions will make you think hard

Challenge

3 In the text below, write two paragraphs to add to the end of the story. Write them clearly and explain what they mean. Write them clearly and explain what they mean.



1 Adventure

> 1.1 The start of an adventure

The narrative structure of a story is the order in which things happen. This includes how a story starts, when different pieces of information are revealed and how the story ends.

Focus

1 Here is a list of nine events from a story. They are in the wrong order. Rearrange these events into the correct order and then write the new order in the following table. The first one has been done for you.

Events

- a Both twins keep their disguises for a month and are unhappy.
- b During the journey, a huge storm occurs, and everybody is washed overboard.
- c Elizabeth also disguises herself – as an old lady – and arrives at the inn.
- d William and Elizabeth are overjoyed to be reunited and return home.
- e Elizabeth also swims to the island and she assumes William has not survived.
- f Twins William and Elizabeth leave home on a small ship.
- g William disguises himself as an old man and gets a job at an inn on the island.
- h One day, a huge wind blows, removing their disguises.
- i William swims to a nearby island and assumes Elizabeth has not survived.

1 Adventure

Correct order of events
f Twins William and Elizabeth leave home on a small ship.

Practice

Most stories are told in chronological order – in the time sequence in which they occur. But some stories use a non-chronological narrative structure. They start with a series of events, then go back in time to explain things that happened earlier.

2 Read the following version of 'Lost at Sea', which is told in non-chronological order. Use different coloured pens to highlight events that occur:

- at the family home
- when the twins are at sea
- on the island.

1.1 The start of an adventure

Lost at Sea

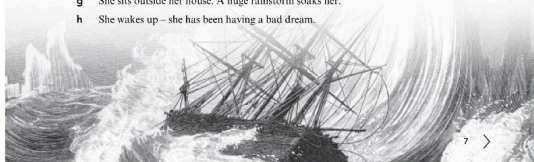
When William and Elizabeth arrived back home, their family were amazed. They couldn't believe it when they walked through the door. William hugged his father and Elizabeth cried as she hugged her mother. They never thought this moment would happen. They could remember swimming through the sea, barely surviving. The ship was destroyed in the storm. They had set off on what they thought was a great adventure across the sea, but as the ship sank, they both lost each other. It was only when that great wind blew off their disguises that they realised the other was alive. William had put on a false beard shortly after he arrived on the island. Elizabeth had also disguised herself. By luck, they had both arrived at the same inn. They were eternally thankful for their good luck as they stood in their parents' house. Being together again was the best feeling ever.

Challenge

3 Look at this list of events. In your notebook, rewrite these events as a story. Use a non-chronological narrative structure. Start by choosing the point you will begin telling the story from.

A Terrible Day

- a A girl wakes up late – she forgot to set an alarm.
- b She leaves home but forgets to take her homework and door key.
- c She runs to school but trips on the way and hurts her knee.
- d In her first lesson, she realises she has forgotten her homework.
- e After school, she walks home alone.
- f She arrives home but can't find her key.
- g She sits outside her house. A huge rainstorm soaks her.
- h She wakes up – she has been having a bad dream.



> 1.2 Quest!

A monologue is a story or speech given by one character, using the first person voice ('I'). This is different to writing in the third person point of view, which means telling the story from an observer's point of view.

Focus

- 1 The following sentences from 'Beware Low-Flying Girls' by Katherine Rundell are written in the third person. Rewrite them in the first person.

Odile walked as far as the paths would take her, clapping her hands together in front and behind her back to keep them warm; and then she climbed.

.....

As Odile climbed, she started to feel tired. Her hands struggled to grip the cliff and her eyes started to close.

.....

Suddenly, Odile felt herself falling. She woke with a start and scrambled to grab hold of the rock.

.....

Practice

- 2 Read the extract from 'Beware Low-Flying Girls', and underline parts of the story or descriptions that you think would appeal to a reader. Make notes on the text to explain your choices.



Without another word, she pulled on her boots and coat and kissed her grandfather's cheek. He waved her away; his skin was colder than usual.

Odile walked as far as the paths would take her, clapping her hands together in front and behind her back to keep them warm; and then she climbed. It was more of a scramble, really, around the edge of the mountain, but there were places where the ground cut away and dropped to a blur below. She did not fly: the wind might drop at any moment, and she didn't like the idea of so much gravity at once.

The first hint that something was wrong was the smell. Odile sniffed. There were seven layers of scent, none of them good: a between-the-toe smell, a week-old-fish smell, an unbrushed-tooth smell; a jackdaw's breath, a cat's sick pool, a burnt **furball** and a sailor's earwax.

'Kraiks,' she whispered.

She looked up, up the edge of the mountainside. She could see nothing – only mist, and branches stretching like arms across the rocks. But a voice came down, thin and quiet.

'Where are you going, little girl?'

Odile said nothing. She set her jaw, and kept climbing, heading sideways.

Helps reader see that grandfather is getting weaker; appeals to reader's feelings of sympathy

jackdaw: a bird (a small crow)
furball: a ball of fur that can develop in an animal's stomach

Challenge

It is important to present a monologue in an engaging voice. You can show voice through word choice and the overall tone.

- 3 Read the last six lines of the extract again. Write a short monologue from the point of view of a Kraik, which is an unpleasant bird-like creature. Use an interesting voice that shows the Kraik's personality.

.....

> 1.3 Train trouble

Language focus

Writers use different types of sentences for different effects. For example, a simple sentence can provide basic, clear detail, but it can also create tension. Compound sentences and complex sentences add detail as well as creating effects, such as conveying excitement. When writing about sentences, try to link your comments about the sentence type to the effect it creates. For example, think about what the shortness of a sentence suggests about the narrator's feelings. Does the detail of a complex sentence help to suggest busyness or panic?

Focus

- 1 Use different colours to highlight the various sentence types (simple, compound, complex) in the following extract from *Around India* in *80 Trains* by Monisha Rajesh.

The train had now picked up speed and was racing through the outskirts of Chennai. I looked around. It was a comfort, if not a concern, that after 20 years the trains looked no different. Limp curtains shielded the windows, miniature cockroaches flitted across the seat backs and the fan still blew **ineffectual** wisps of air. A part of me feared that I would board my first train and instantly regret my decision. What if I hated it? Four whole months within these blue walls lay ahead.

ineffectual: useless

Practice

- 2 Complete the following table by writing in your own examples of different sentence types.

Sentence type	Example
Simple sentence	
Compound sentence	
Complex sentence	

Challenge

- 3 In your notebook, write a paragraph that contains different sentence types. Use one of these pictures to inspire you, or write about something from your own imagination.



> 1.4 A hard journey

Language focus

Poets often use different types of sound effects, such as alliteration and sibilance. These sound patterns are effective when the poem is read aloud. They are used sometimes for very specific effects.

Alliteration is when consonant sounds are repeated at the start of words (for example, 'the rifle's rapid rattle' – the repeated 'r' sound brings to mind the stuttering sound of a gun being fired).

Sibilance is the repetition of soft consonant sounds, usually the 's' sound (for example, 'the ship moved slowly through the sea' – the repeated 's' sound brings to mind the sound of a ship moving through water, or the sound of the wind making the ship move).

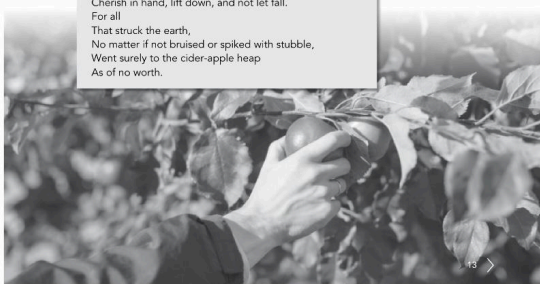
Focus

- 1 Read the two extracts from the poem 'After Apple-Picking' by Robert Frost. It is about a man who has spent the day picking apples and is very tired. Use two colours to highlight examples of sibilance and alliteration.

Essence of winter sleep is on the night,
The scent of apples: I am drowsing off.
I cannot rub the strangeness from my sight
I got from looking through a pane of glass
I skimmed this morning from the drinking trough
And held against the world of **hoary** grass.
It melted, and I let it fall and break.

hoary: covered in frost

I feel the ladder sway as the boughs bend.
And I keep hearing from the cellar bin
The rumbling sound
Of load on load of apples coming in.
For I have had too much
Of apple-picking: I am overtired
Of the great harvest I myself desired.
There were ten thousand thousand fruit to touch,
Cherish in hand, lift down, and not let fall.
For all
That struck the earth,
No matter if not bruised or spiked with stubble,
Went surely to the cider-apple heap
As of no worth.



Practice

- 2 What effect is created by the examples you have spotted from 'After Apple-Picking'? Choose one example of sibilance and one of alliteration and make notes on the text to explain the examples.

Challenge

- 3 Try writing your own sentences using the sound patterns covered in this session. Start with the following ideas:

a a description of a stormy sea

b the sounds of a battle

c a busy city at night

> 1.5 Danger!

Language focus

To create excitement in suspense stories, writers often use verbs that suggest movement and power. In the first paragraph of *Silverfin* by Charlie Higson there are lots of 'action' verbs, including *struggled*, *gripping* and *slid*. These powerful verbs create excitement in the story, helping the reader imagine the movement and danger that the character is experiencing. Verbs build intensity, so choosing a powerful verb like *struggled* is often more effective in creating excitement than the choice of adjective.

Focus

- 1 Read the following extract from *Silverfin* by Charlie Higson. Underline ten interesting and/or powerful verbs. One has been done for you.

Every insane decision he'd taken so far had paid off: going down the branch of the pine tree, swinging on to the wall, climbing down the well shaft, dropping into the pool . . . He had to trust in his own crazy guardian angel.

He let out another bubble of air and pulled himself into the gap, which scraped him on all sides, grazing his spine. But he could still go forward, wriggling like an eel himself, pushing with knees and elbows, crawling with his fingertips along the rock. He was going to make it. He'd made the right choice. He let out the last of his breath and squirmed forward, racing against time, his blood singing in his ears, his head wanting to explode, his lungs full of acid.

And then he stopped.

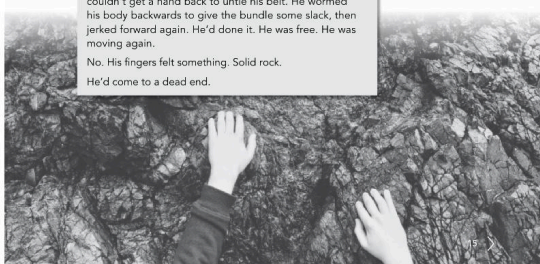
He could go no further.

What was it?

One of the bundles had got caught behind him. He jerked his hips to try and free it. Come on! Come on! He couldn't get a hand back to untie his belt. He wormed his body backwards to give the bundle some slack, then jerked forward again. He'd done it. He was free. He was moving again.

No. His fingers felt something. Solid rock.

He'd come to a dead end.



Practice

- 2 Look at the powerful verbs you underlined in the extract. Choose five of them and suggest replacements for these verbs that have a similar effect. Use a thesaurus to help you.

Verb in text	Replacement
1	
2	
3	
4	
5	

Challenge

- 3 Write a paragraph describing one of the following scenes. Use interesting and/or powerful verbs that help the reader to picture the scene.
- an out-of-control car heading through a tunnel
 - a huge, unexpected storm during a sports game
 - a wild animal walking through a busy town.



> 1.6 Creating suspense

Writers use different methods to create suspense. Careful choice of words and phrases can help to create a feeling of danger. The way a story is structured also helps to create suspense.

Focus

- 1 Read the following story and underline words and phrases that suggest danger.

I stood on the cliff face and looked down at the furious, boiling waters – I'd dreamt of this moment. The air. The sea. The freedom. My dreams of liberty and closeness to nature had led me here. Further along this cliff face was a place of wonder: it was a cave rumoured to contain strange, beautiful creatures that only a few humans had seen. But to get to the cave, I would need to leap into the ocean then climb up to the cave. This was no easy thing. People had died attempting such a feat – it was madness.

All my life I had avoided danger. But sometimes, life has a strange way of opening your eyes. The ocean looked angry; the ocean was certain death.

The air is so fresh here. There is a comfort in the hypnotic noise of the seabirds, calling you into possible destruction. I breathed deeply, controlling my fear, reminding myself of the reason I was here. Even with my eyes shut, I could see the vivid colours of sea and sky. The sea was beautiful.

This will be a symbolic fall. I may not make it.

Practice

- 2 Read the following outline of a story. Write a paragraph in which you:
- explain what the main cause of suspense is in the story
 - explain the point where the suspense ends.

Hospital Story

- a A girl and her parents are walking into a hospital.
- b None of the characters speak as they walk down a long corridor.
- c The girl wonders what the doctor will say.
- d They enter the ward and see lots of doctors and nurses gathered around a bed.
- e There is a boy on the bed – it's the girl's brother.
- f The brother isn't moving.
- g A doctor asks to speak to the family in private.
- h The family wait in another room quietly.
- i The doctor enters after 30 minutes.
- j He tells the family that the boy will make a full recovery.

Challenge

- 3 Choose a section from 'Hospital Story' that contains suspense. In your notebook, write your own version of this section. Use the methods you have learnt to create suspense, including:
- the right voice
 - sound patterns
 - sentence types
 - word choices.

2 'Hey, You Down There'

> 2.1 Calvin and Dora

Language focus

Writers choose sentence openings carefully to show the reader how events in a story or points in an argument are connected. These connections may relate to:

- **when** (time/sequence of events): for example, 'Later that day ...' tells the reader that time has moved on in a story
- **where** (location or context): for example, 'On the other side of the road ...' indicates a new setting in relation to the previous one
- **how** (comparison/contrast): for example, 'In the same way ...' suggests that what comes next is similar to what came before
- **why** (relationship between events): for example, 'Because of the bad weather ...' shows a cause, which will be followed by a consequence.

Focus

- 1 Match these sentence openings to their function. Draw a line between the sentence opening and the correct description of its function in the right-hand column.

Sentence opening

On the contrary ...
After dinner ...
Back at the hotel ...
As a result ...

Purpose

To indicate a shift in time
To show a change in location
To suggest how one event relates to another
To make a comparison